

Second Bull Run and Chancellorsville, the injured lay in agony on the field for days, or in some cases, more than a week, and thus were far less likely to survive. Jonathan W. Letterman, medical director of the Army of the Potomac, recognized the need for speedy evacuation of the wounded, and to that end created a Federal Ambulance Corps composed of specially selected and trained litter bearers, ambulance drivers and horses, and specifically constructed ambulances. These reforms succeeded in saving thousands of Union soldiers' lives. The Confederates experimented with similar ideas, but failed to create an efficient, army-wide field evacuation apparatus. Both armies utilized a tripartite system: regimental dressing stations directly behind the front lines, divisional field hospitals (often set up in local barns, houses, or churches), and formal military hospitals in the cities (such as Richmond's famous Chimborazo) for those wounded who required long convalescences.